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On the forefront of worldly radiological innovation, education and mentorship – A tribute to Dr. Theresa McLoud

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ABSTRACT

Dr. Theresa McLoud is a true pioneer in thoracic radiology. Her considerable involvement in numerous radiological societies is reflected by her many leadership positions and the esteemed awards she has received. By participating in prevalent conversations with other leaders in the field, Dr. McLoud has shown true devotion to the advancement of radiology across the globe. Her passion for mentorship has impacted the lives of many students, residents, and trainees. Dr. McLoud balances compassion with instruction by treating her trainees with kindness while ensuring high academic and professional standards. Dr. McLoud has shown steadfast dedication to the advancement of radiology in all aspects of her career; she is genuinely an extraordinary trailblazer in radiology.

1. The origins of a trailblazer

Dr. McLoud's incredible life story started in Boston, Massachusetts, where her interest in medicine was sparked by a family friend who was a family medicine physician. With her father's support, she met with a medical career advisor at Boston College, where she later pursued her undergraduate degree. Her determination to fight gender norms was evident from the start, as only two to three women were in each medical school class.

Dr. McLoud attended medical school at McGill University Faculty of Medicine in Montreal, Canada. She continued her training at the Royal Victoria Hospital in Montreal, known for its exceptional radiology department. Her experience in Canada was enriching in many respects. Dr. McLoud gained invaluable experience training in a new country. The British influence brought significant diversity to her school, with classmates from Nigeria and other British Commonwealth countries. In addition to the diverse student body, the education she received at McGill University was exemplary, as the institution was well-recognized as one of the best in Canada (see Fig. 1).

2. Cultivating expertise in radiology

Dr. McLoud returned to the northeast United States for a fellowship in thoracic radiology at Yale-New Haven Hospital in Connecticut,

followed by a position as an assistant professor in diagnostic radiology at Yale University. In 1976, Dr. McLoud returned to Boston to work at Harvard Medical School's Massachusetts General Hospital. In 1993, Dr. McLoud made history by becoming the first female radiologist to be awarded the rank of professor at Harvard's Massachusetts General Hospital, marking an awe-inspiring achievement. Dr. McLoud reflects on this position as a tremendous honor.

Since this time, Dr. McLoud has continued her meaningful work at Massachusetts General Hospital by holding a vast array of positions, including the chief of Thoracic Radiology from 1982 to 1996, chief of Thoracic and Cardiac Radiology from 1996 to 2001, and member of the Board of Trustees of Massachusetts General Hospital.² Until recently, she was the vice chair of education and program director in the Department of Radiology. Dr. McLoud's devotion to advancing radiology is evidenced by her publication of over 200 influential scientific papers, reviews, and book chapters. Her textbook, *Thoracic Radiology: The Requisites*, has significantly impacted many generations of radiologists as the comprehensive guide to thoracic imaging. Despite her numerous roles, Dr. McLoud consistently upheld her clinical responsibilities and continues to practice her passion for interpreting images in thoracic radiology (see Fig. 2).

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Fig. 1. Dr. Theresa McLoud.

3. Empowering growth through mentorship

Dr. McLoud's career path was heavily influenced by two Chairmen, Drs. Fraser and Thrall. During her medical training, Dr. Robert Fraser was the Chairman of the Department of Radiology at McGill University. Dr. Robert Fraser was a world-renowned thoracic radiologist dedicated to his work. He was a wonderful mentor who was very supportive of Dr. McLoud. Dr. McLoud dedicated many hours in the radiology department under the mentorship of Dr. Fraser, who significantly enhanced her passion for thoracic radiology.

Dr. James Thrall was the Chairman of the Department of Radiology at Harvard's Massachusetts General Hospital during much of Dr. McLoud's career. Dr. James Thrall helped Dr. McLoud kickstart her career by inviting her to oversee the Diagnostic Radiology Residency Program. He envisioned the future of the radiology department as

dependent on the young talent that was yet to come in. Dr. McLoud similarly found importance in recruiting and training a diverse cohort of residents, who would each contribute uniquely to the department's overall success. Her appreciation for culture was evident in her resident recruitment, as she successfully assembled many diverse radiology resident cohorts with people from various backgrounds across the nation and globe.

As Dr. McLoud reflects on her career, she finds her work in education and mentorship to be the most rewarding aspects of her professional journey. She finds great pleasure in working with residents and fellows and views her relationship with the trainees as a privilege. Getting to know the residents as individuals and witnessing their talents shine in radiology brings her special joy. She deeply values the opportunity to guide and nurture residents through challenging times in their professional development. Her genuine dedication to mentorship is evident in



DEPARTMENT OF RADIOLOGY, JUNE 1979

TOP ROW: Rhea, Sabel, Honickman
8th ROW: Benacerraf, McChesney, Stark, Lader
7th ROW: Newhouse, Geller, Baltarowich, Roemer, Greenstein
6th ROW: Hesselink, Paley, Gordon, Scott, Diamant, Butch
5th ROW: Winzelberg, McCarthy, Gallant, DeLuca, Dedrick
4th ROW: Rosenthal, Neff, vanSonnenberg, Kopans, Sacknoff, J. Davis
3rd ROW: Rich, Vick, Coleman, Mueller, Harbin, Isler, Stock
2nd ROW: Kirkpatrick, Murray, Castronovo, Miller, Potsaid
1st ROW: Ferrucci, Webster, Taveras, Wyman, Robbins, McCloud
MISSING: Arpin, Caminhe, Grotta, Harley, Olson, Peyster, Zito
Fellows: Chang, Dietz, Froelich, Gadziala, Grant, Kieser, Metzger, O'Malley, Spirn
Staff: Ackerman, Aronow, Athanasoulis, Bauman, Cleveland, K. Davis, Dinsmore, Dreyfuss, Greene, Greenfield, Hauser, Hinshaw, LeMay, Llewellyn, McCarten, McKusick, Momose, New, Novelline, Pfister, Simeone, Strauss

Fig. 2. The Department of Radiology at Massachusetts General Hospital, 1979. First row far right: Dr. Theresa McCloud.



Fig. 3. Dr. McLoud with then resident, Dr. Florian Fintelmann, MD.

the fact that she viewed her trainees like her children and family members (see Figs. 3 and 4).

4. Expanding horizons in radiological societies

Her noteworthy involvement in many highly regarded radiological societies reflects Dr. McLoud's global perspective. She has served as president of the Radiological Society of North America, the American Roentgen Ray Society, the Fleischner Society, and the Society of Thoracic Radiology.¹ Her influential impact on many societies is highlighted by her many awards, including gold medals from the American Roentgen Ray Society in 2003, the Society of Thoracic Radiology in 2010, the International Cancer Imaging Society in 2012, and the Radiological Society of North America in 2013. Her dedication to radiology is internationally recognized, as she received honorary membership in numerous international organizations, including the European, Spanish, Argentinian, Italian, Mexican, Australia-New Zealand, and French Societies of Radiology and the Faculty of Medicine in Radiology of the Royal College of Surgeons of Ireland.³ Of special note, she received the Marie Curie Award in 2003, the highest honor of the American Association for Women Radiologists, signifying her outstanding contribution to the advancement of women in radiology.

Dr. McLoud deeply appreciates how these organizations support the career development of young professionals by bringing together brilliant people with innovative ideas at annual meetings and conferences. She actively served on numerous committees where she engaged in discussions on prevalent subjects such as best resident training practices, embracing new challenges in radiology, or ensuring the wide availability of newly published information. Her involvement took her across the globe, to Europe and Asia, where she exchanged ideas with other dedicated radiologists. She reflects fondly on the unique relationships and friendships she formed through these organizations, and how her career was truly enriched by the community and collaboration within

these organizations (see Fig. 5).

5. A worldly outlook

Despite Dr. McLoud's unwavering dedication to radiology, she maintained a broad, worldly perspective. Her love for music took her to numerous matinees and operas each year, while her passion for leisure travel took her across the globe. Dr. McLoud deeply values understanding diverse cultures. She inherited this passion from her father, a Professor of Latin and Greek, who spent his summer breaks traveling to Europe by ship in the 1930s. During her travels for radiological society conferences, Dr. McLoud reveled in the culture of each country she visited by spending time getting to know the culture, often being hosted by local radiologists. Dr. McLoud's enthusiasm for travel continues to take her across the globe today.

6. A legacy of dedication, innovation, and education

Dr. McLoud's training was instrumental in her emergence as a trailblazer in radiology. Her radiology residency class in Canada comprised fifteen trainees, with three women. At the time, having even a few women within one program was rare. Despite this challenge, Dr. McLoud used her determination and skill to excel. This foundation of perseverance proved invaluable as Dr. McLoud pioneered a path forward for both herself and other women in the field of radiology.

Dr. McLoud's legacy is one of dedication, innovation, and education. Her devotion to the field of radiology is demonstrated not only by her significant impact in international radiological societies but also by her transformative touch on the lives of her many trainees. Her unparalleled passion for the advancement of the field is second to none. Because of Dr. McLoud's impact, the field of radiology and countless radiologists are ever enriched.



Fig. 4. Dr. McLoud presents the Dr. Greene award to then resident, Dr. Walker. From left to right: Drs. Greene, McLoud, Walker, and Gee.



Fig. 5. Dr. McCloud attends a conference for Women in Radiology, 2018.

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Laura Avery: Supervision, Writing – review & editing. **Nina Nariman:** Writing – original draft, Writing – review & editing.

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